

group conscience and pass on that legacy through sponsorship. Our service people are well educated in the writings of A.A. and Bill W. We cross all boundaries and ethnic lines, and proudly look to our two linguistic districts that prosper and provide the message to our large Hispanic population. Area 92 is coming of age and Unity is our standard. We are proud to be one of two areas that host the Pacific NW Conference, started by a suggestion of Bill's in 1948, and to be a member of the Pacific Region where PRAASA is such a great service experience. We will be there when and if any hand reaches for help, and we will be there as a part of A.A. as a whole. — *Mike McMurtrie*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has over 600 groups divided among 24 districts in the northern half of Wisconsin and most of the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. We have two assemblies and two conferences annually, and a Unity Conference, shared with Area 75. We have a new format for our area committee to meet at least four times per year. Prior to the Conference, we have a delegate's workshop where our committees make recommendations to the assembly, who in turn make recommendations for the delegate to New York. Sharing sessions happen quite often during the year and many good ideas are brought forth. The Northern half of Wisconsin and the UP of Michigan have traveling speaker meetings monthly, which are sponsored by districts. At these events G.S.R.s have a sharing session and sometimes corrections sharing also. Fellowship, recovery, unity, and service prevail at these monthly speaker meetings. Our area archivist is diligently preserving our history. Our corrections committee is in the process of developing a better "bridging the gap" system, as is our treatment facilities committee. We are striving to carry the message of happiness, joy, and freedom to the still-suffering alcoholic. The theme for this year's Conference is "Our Singleness of Purpose—The Cornerstone of A.A." and the Spirit of the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and The Twelve Concepts for World Services to observe this shall guide Area 74. — *Torvin Theisen*

Wyoming: Area 76 has 108 registered groups and spans 97,914 square miles in 12 districts, with approximately 1,950 members. We hold two business assemblies each year, in March and mid-August. Assemblies are rotated to various small communities to involve as many as possible. We also hold two area conventions each year, rotating between larger cities. This March we hosted the West-Central Regional A.A. Service Conference, which comes to our area once every eight years, in Cheyenne. Our members also enjoy campouts, jamborees, and other get-togethers to celebrate sobriety. They take meetings to our prisons in Rawlins and Lusk, our honor farms and local jails on a monthly and weekly basis. We have a full-time archivist, who is preserving Wyoming A.A. history. They are currently transferring many of our audio archives to CD format. *The Tributary*, the area newsletter, is published four times per year. We currently updated our area Web site to provide meeting lists from our 12 districts. Wyoming members are as rugged as the wilderness we live in, but also have technology at our fingertips. Our members are helping other alcoholics get and stay sober through their meetings and Twelfth Step calls without so much as one complaint. We continually see growth, sometimes quickly, sometimes slowly. These members give of themselves freely, honoring our primary purpose everywhere they are asked. I am honored to be a part of such a wonderful, loving, and caring group of A.A. members. Come on out and see us some time, the coffee's always on, arms open, and in some cases during our cold and wintry nights, willing to be there just for you. We'd be quite glad to see ya! — *Don Myers*

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the trustees' Conference Committee review the rating scale to offer a broader choice of responses.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and suggested including a bibliography of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine publications of historic interest.
- The committee asked the trustees to review and clarify how the "Ownership of Material" statement in the Workbook relates to material collected at the G.S.O. Archives.
- The committee reviewed the "Guidelines for Collecting Oral Histories" and expressed their appreciation to the trustees' Archives Committee for developing the document. The revised Guidelines will replace the oral history section currently included in the Archives Workbook.
- The committee expressed their appreciation For the revised editorial vision and reformatted design of *Markings, Your Archives Interchange* newsletter. The committee asked the trustees' committee to explore possibilities for wider distribution of the newsletter along with the related costs involved.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and made several suggestions:
 1. The list of C.P.C. pamphlets and videos on page 30 denote which ones are available in English, French and Spanish.
 2. The Kit and Workbook be made consistent in English, French and Spanish, noting that in order to do this it would be necessary for some materials to be translated.
 3. That the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" be included in the Kit.
 4. That a section titled "Singleness of Purpose" be added to the Workbook. It would read:

"This statement of 'Singleness of Purpose' has been added to pamphlets intended to share information about A.A. with professionals:

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings.

This is in keeping with the long form of A.A.'s Third and Fifth Traditions:



Third Tradition—Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation.

Fifth Tradition—Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity *having but one primary purpose* — that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers.”

5. That the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities gather sharing for possible inclusion in the Workbook on ways that C.P.C. committees approach professionals, such as contacting professional associations, to add to the existing sharing regarding sending letters.

- The committee discussed ways C.P.C. committees can help when it comes to individuals referred to A.A. who focus on problems other than alcohol at A.A. meetings, and agreed that the following are useful suggestions:

1. Spending time one-on-one with professionals.
2. Making use of available A.A. literature.
3. Asking local professional friends of A.A. and utilizing A.A.s employed in professional fields to participate in C.P.C. work.
4. Informing professionals about the difference between open and closed A.A. meetings and encouraging them to refer people to open meetings.
5. Working with professionals to coordinate orientation meetings for people referred to A.A.
6. Sharing information about twelve step groups that focus on problems other than alcoholism.
7. Making sure that all A.A. members, not only those doing C.P.C. work, are familiar with all A.A.'s Traditions.

- The committee shared local experience and emphasized the benefits of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information, and Treatment Facilities committees cooperating and working together to carry the message.

- The committee discussed ways of reaching a wider variety of professionals, including lawyers, police officers, counselors and

others involved in the social welfare system, educators, mental health professionals, as well as professionals who interact with young people. They encouraged local committee sharing about literature that may be useful in informing legal professionals about A.A.

- The committee also noted the importance of contacting professionals who serve those who speak other languages.

- The committee requested that the trustees' committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities review the inclusion of the name of a Class A trustee in the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous."

- The committee requested that the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook be made available in a three-ring binder format similar to the Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities Kits.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee supports the proposed name change from "trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities" to "trustees' Committee on Corrections."

- The committee accepted with appreciation the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' progress report on the revision of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* and looks forward to receiving a draft manuscript at the 2005 General Service Conference.

- The committee selected and reformatted generic prerelease brochures from the samples forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities and requested that they be included in both the Correctional Facilities Workbook and under a new tab in the Correctional Facilities Kit.

- The committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities present a report to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities on the feasibility and cost of producing and distributing a video featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.

- The committee unanimously requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities continue to gather and review additional sharing from area delegates and Correctional Committee, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Bridging the Gap area chairs on the topic of introducing A.A. into training programs for correctional personnel, and that they use this information to write guidelines to present to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for the development of workshops and training sessions on introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.

FINANCE

- The committee spent considerable time discussing sponsorship and the spiritual aspects of voluntary contributions. We agreed that membership and support of a home group is the fundamental cornerstone of A.A. Participation centered at the home group will support our primary purpose to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

- The committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee review the level of delegate area participation (delegate fees and area contributions) to the General Service Conference forwarding this information to the 2005 Conference Finance Committee.



GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the draft of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and suggested certain editorial changes be made prior to publication.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested:

1. That information regarding Regional and Special Forums emphasize that Forums can benefit *all* A.A. members and not just those members involved in general service.
2. That a small souvenir might be provided as memento of the Forum for all attendees.
3. That information regarding Regional and Special Forums be mailed earlier.
4. That areas with web sites consider linking to the General Service Office Web site in order to provide members in the area with easier access to information about Regional and Special Forums.

LITERATURE

- After lengthy discussion, the committee requested that the Publications Department rewrite the draft introduction to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, as recommended by the 2003 General Service Conference, taking into consideration suggestions from the committee, and present it to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee considered the suggestion that the trustees' Literature Committee develop comic books for the new and younger members in the Fellowship, and took no action.

- The committee considered the request to develop a booklet for teenagers, similar to the booklets *Living Sober, Came to Believe*, and *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, and took no action.

- The committee considered the request to restore punctuation in "Dr. Bob's Nightmare" in the Fourth Edition as it appears in the Third Edition of the Big Book and after lengthy discussion and with unified consensus, agreed to take no action.

- The committee reviewed the draft manuscript of a new comic book format pamphlet to replace the pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" and requested that the Publications Department present a storyboard draft to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for consideration following review by the trustees' Literature Committee. The committee made some suggestions for changes to the sample manuscript.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees' Literature Committee progress report on the comprehensive review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet recommended by the 2003 General Service Conference. The committee noted that the deadline for suggestions to changes in the pamphlet was January 2004. A draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet will be presented to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for review.

- The committee considered the request to develop a separate and specific intergroup/central office pamphlet and took no action. The committee suggested that "The A.A. Group" pamphlet include a definition of intergroup/central offices in the section "The A.A. group's relations with others in the community" on page 33 to be taken from the "A.A. Guidelines on Central or Intergroup Offices."

- The committee considered the requested revisions to the pamphlet "Your A.A. General Service Office" pertaining to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña and requested that the trustees' Literature Committee, in consultation with the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, review the section titled "The A.A. Grapevine" for revisions to reflect current practices and accuracy, and present a revised draft of the section to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider changing the reference to "personal digital assistants" to "*personal digital assistants (PDAs) with a keyboard requiring power*" in Section Definitions I. of the "Guidelines for PC Users at the General Service Conference."

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider forwarding a recommendation to the 2005 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions regarding the broader use of self-powered personal digital assistants (PDAs) and/or similar electronic devices with no attachments for note taking at the General Service Conference.

- The committee concurred with the A.A.W.S. Board's report indicating that the use of a CD format is the most practical method of electronically distributing Conference background material. The committee requested that the current statement of confidentiality be prominently displayed in the proposed CD format. If the CD format becomes available, the committee requested that Conference members be offered the option of receiving the General Service Conference Final Agendas and all corresponding background materials in either CD format and/or paper format.

- In response to a request from the A.A.W.S. Board, the committee encourages full Conference input on the ramifications

of electronic distribution of Conference agendas and background material.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee viewed the proposed television Public Service Announcement (P.S.A.) — “Living in Chaos” — developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, expressed deep appreciation for the concept and the diversity portrayed, and asked that the first segment be re-filmed and the amended version of “Living in Chaos” be forwarded to the 2005 Conference P. I. Committee.
- The committee considered centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the proposed television P.S.A. — “Living in Chaos” — at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, in addition to the work of local P.I. committees and, as there will be no new P.S.A. this year, the committee took no action.
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the “We Know What It’s Like” Public Service Announcement.
- The committee requested that all Conference Areas review whether and how Alcoholics Anonymous is listed in the white pages of local phone books.
- The committee requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee submit a report to the 2005 Conference Committee on Public Information which includes feasibility, costs and timelines for updating/replacing the two videos “A.A. — Rap With Us” and “Young People in A.A.”
- The committee requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee review the radio Public Service Announcement, “Teenager,” spot number 6 on item #R-10, and report back to the 2005 Conference Committee on Public Information regarding the sentence “I started drinking and taking pills” in relation to the spirit of our singleness of purpose.
- The committee reviewed contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* with appreciation, and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department for their consideration. The committee also requested that the Publications Department consider reviewing the format and quality of the current *Service Manual*.
- The committee discussed a suggestion that the *Conference Final Report* be mailed in English, French and Spanish at the same time and took no action.
- The committee discussed the purpose and usefulness of the Eastern and Western United States, Canada and International A.A. Directories, and agreed with the 2003 Report and Charter Conference Committee that the directories continue to be useful and serve the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee expressed appreciation for the new three-ring binder Treatment Facilities Kit format.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit and requested that the Singleness of Purpose Statement

currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets be included in the Treatment Facilities Workbook, and that the Fall/Winter 2002 and Fall 2003 issues of *About A.A.* be included in the Treatment Facilities Kit.

- The committee requested that the A.A.W.S. Board review the price of the Treatment Facilities Kit.
- The committee discussed Treatment Facilities area and district committee service work at homeless shelters, halfway houses, outpatient treatment programs, and nursing homes. Committee sharing indicated that in some areas Special Needs or Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees contact nursing home personnel; in other areas, Treatment Facilities Committees perform this valuable service work.
- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap activities, which also reflected a wide range of experience. The committee discovered that in some areas the Treatment Facilities Committee and Correctional Facilities Committee do their own Bridging the Gap work and in other areas a separate Bridging the Gap committee has this responsibility.
- The committee requested that the Treatment Facilities staff person request further shared experience on the scope of Treatment Facilities Committee activities from areas, districts, and intergroups/central offices in the U.S. and Canada.
- The committee discussed ways of carrying A.A.’s message of singleness of purpose, which includes mailing letters and making visits to treatment facilities professionals, and conducting workshops for A.A. members and professionals on what A.A. is and is not.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and changed the wording of item #2 under the “Scope” section to read as follows:

“The committee reviews the resumes of all newly-nominated Class A and Class B trustees of The General Service Board and nontrustee directors of the corporate boards (A.A.W.S. and The A.A. Grapevine). The committee reviews the slates of members and officers of The General Service Board and the slates of corporate board directors, before the Conference meeting, and expresses disapproval, if any.”

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for West Central and Western Canada regional trustees.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the trustees’ Committee on Correctional Facilities continue to gather and review additional sharing from area delegates and Correctional Committee, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Bridging the Gap Area chairs on the topic of introducing A.A. into *educational* programs for correctional personnel, and that they use this information to write guidelines to present to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for the development of workshops and *education* sessions on introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.
- That the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board produce a collection of stories for young people, drawn from previous issues of the A.A. Grapevine magazine, similar to “Spiritual Awakenings.”